

Google My Business Setup Guide

What Is Google My Business?

Google My Business (now called Google Business Profile) is the free listing that appears when someone searches for your business on Google or Google Maps. It's one of the most impactful free tools available to a small business — and most craft businesses never set it up properly.

Step 1 — Create or Claim Your Profile

1. Go to business.google.com
2. Sign in with your Google account
3. Search for your business name — it may already exist
4. If it exists: click "Claim this business"
5. If not: click "Add your business to Google"

Step 2 — Fill In Every Section

Business name: Your real trading name — no keyword stuffing.

Category: Choose the most specific category. "Pottery store", "Craft store", "Artist's studio" etc.

Address: If you work from home, you can hide your address but still set a service area.

Phone and website: Add both. A missing phone number reduces trust.

Hours: Set accurate hours. Update them for holidays — Google penalises businesses that show wrong hours.

Description (750 chars): Describe what you make, your location, and what makes you different. Include your main keywords naturally.

Step 3 — Add Photos

Businesses with photos receive 42% more requests for directions and 35% more website clicks. Add:

- A cover photo: your best product shot
- Profile photo: your logo or a portrait
- 5–10 product photos

Step 4 — Get Reviews

Reviews are the #1 factor in local search ranking. Ask happy customers directly: "Would you mind leaving a Google review? It really helps." Send them a direct link from your Business Profile dashboard.

Step 5 — Post Regularly

Google lets you post updates, events, and offers. One post per week improves your ranking. These posts appear in your listing and in search results.